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To the Editors, *Software: Practice and Experience*

Re: Submission — “Protocol-Governed Computing: Architectural Inversion, Its Consequences, and a Scaling Claim”

Dear Editors,

I submit the manuscript above for consideration as a Research Article.

What the paper is about. Conventional software architecture distributes authority to determine behavior across several sources. Declarations govern some behavior; implementation code, build tooling, and runtime mechanisms determine the rest. The paper examines an architecture that reverses this arrangement: governed declarations determine authorized behavior, including business rules, while construction, implementation, and execution realize that determination rather than independently supplying it. The reversal is derived from five architectural properties, each established in prior work, against six conventional assumptions. Their contradiction yields a systematic set of inversions across governance, orchestration, engineering, and scale.

Why SPE. The contribution is software architecture and its consequences for construction, execution, evolution, and scaling—not language design, a formal-methods result, or a process proposal. The paper states what the architecture makes possible, what it refuses, and what becomes computable about a change before it is made. Engineering consequences are treated as architectural consequences; the paper makes no claims about cost, delivery time, staffing, or defect rates. A reference realization is deposited and citable and is inspected as evidence rather than taken on trust.

What is novel. First, the paper derives the joint implication of five previously established properties against conventional assumptions; the contribution is their conjunction, not any individual property. Second, it derives two consequences rather than assuming them: execution preserves authority rather than creating it, and changing the worker does not change the authority of the resulting system. The latter bears directly on machine-speed software generation: activity throughput can increase without transferring authority over system behavior to the worker. Third, the paper separates claims by epistemic status: derived, exercised by the reference realization, or predicted and awaiting measurement.

I am an independent researcher with more than forty years of experience in large-systems integration and systems architecture. The problem addressed here is one I encountered repeatedly in practice: systems that work while no single artifact determines what they may do.

The manuscript is original, is not under consideration elsewhere, and has not been published previously. There is no funding and no conflict of interest.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Bhash Ganti